

Tell us how you're feeling!



Education Session #2

Articulating Value: Odyssey, Resume & Behavioral Questions



***Reminder for Ed team: RECORD*

September 17, 2023

- AVP Roles - Next steps
- Last week's feedback
- In-Person / Coffee Chat Corporate Presentation Reminders
- Helpful How-To's
- Odyssey
 - Why have one?
 - How to highlight your background
 - The components
 - Odyssey Observe-a-Pro
- Resumes
- Behavioral Questions
 - What are they?
 - Picking stories

AVP Roles - Next Steps

- AVP application will be sent out shortly
 - Application describes key responsibilities

Ashley and Smarak were AVPs of Education, and got the chance to:

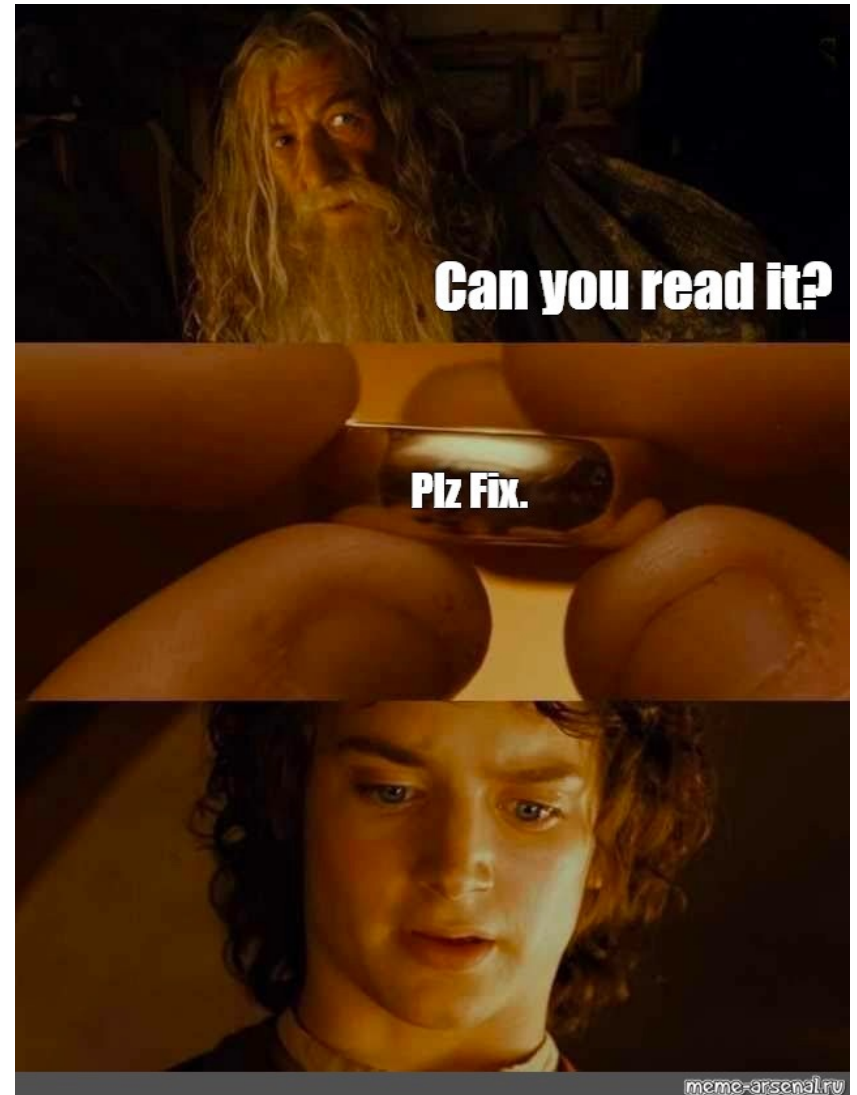
- Work with MBA2s on helping design Sunday sessions
- Bring in MBA1 experiences to MBA2s, and highlight areas of development and support
- Interact with other schools for their casebooks...

...and do so much more!

Last Week's Feedback

We hear you:

- More chairs, more tables!
- Interactive elements, live demos and MBA2 experiences (E.g., panel and stories)
- Common mistakes/ pro tips



In-Person / Coffee Chat Corporate Presentation Reminders

All in-person events

- Check the dress code (many are business casual)
 - Think ahead: do I need to arrive to class dressed for the event? Do I have a change of clothes in my Ross locker?
- Wear your Ross nametag on your shirt
- Remember that this is a *professional event*
 - Consider your consumption at events

Coffee chat specific

- Have a paper copy of your resume to share if asked
- Have a pen and a notepad handy to take notes (this is a life-saver)



We know that when corporate presentations start that your evenings start getting crunched! Preparing ahead is the best way to mitigate this.

Remember: if you register for an event, you MUST attend!

Prudent Networking Reminders

	Expectations	You are aiming to...	...but NOT
Coffee Chats	• Talk to the other person like a person! :) • If you missed your chance, there will be many more	• "Why this firm" beyond the presentation	• Networking to get the interview (firms are trying to get to know you still)
Corporate Presentations	• Be present (literally and attention-wise)	• Learn about the firm, their core competencies, and begin to note things relevant to you for this firm • "Why this firm"	• Be remembered (MANY will attend)

Last Week:

- Consulting recruiting – rules of the game
- Resume development
- Networking first principles

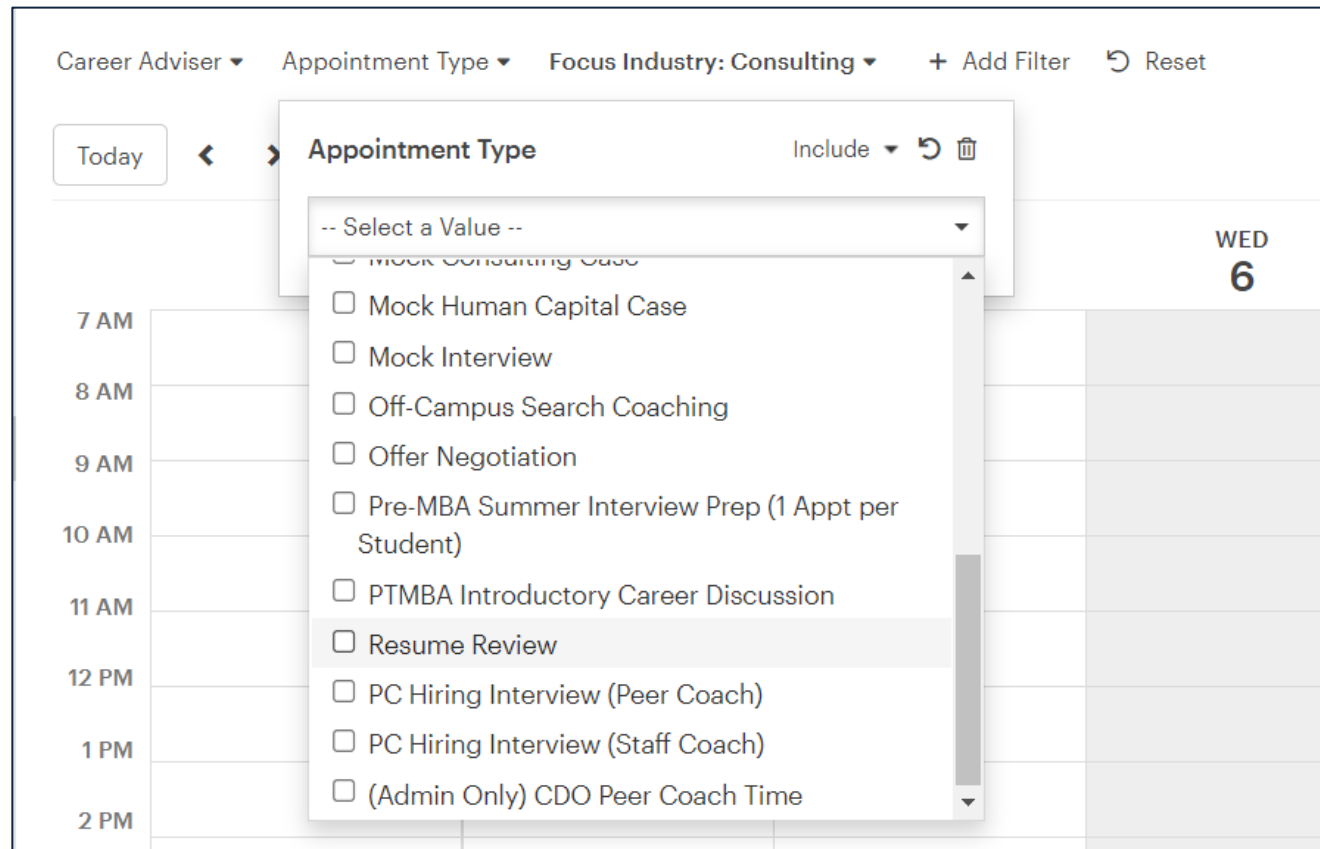
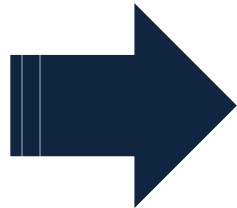
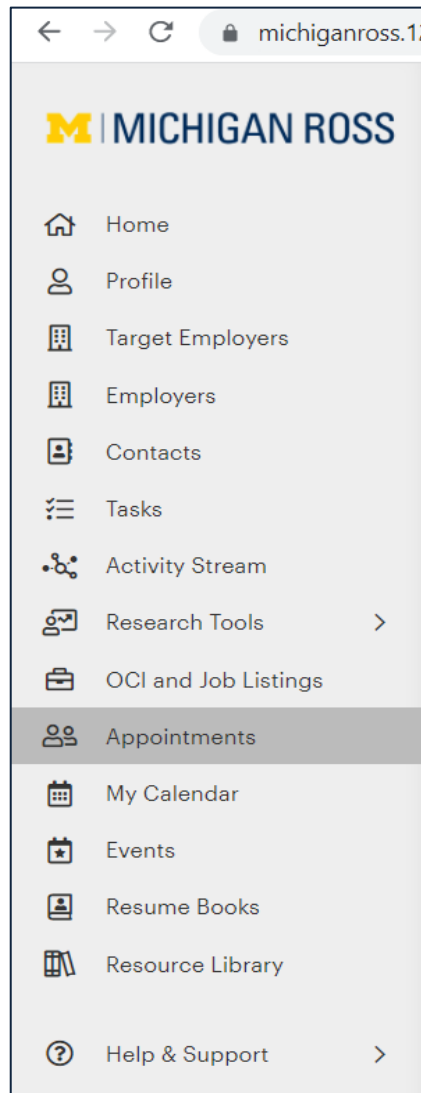


This Week:

- Continue resume development
- Developing & practicing your Odyssey/elevator pitch and “Why Consulting”
- Kickoff story selection for behavioral interviews
- Sign up for CDO and Peer Coach appointments (non-consulting) on RR!

Booking appointments on Ross Recruit & CDO resources

Ross Recruit: michiganross.12twenty.com



Note: usually you are changing the focus industry to “Consulting.” However, consulting peer coaches are currently helping MBA2s with re-recruiting. You can use general management peer coaches or any peer coach who was previously working as a consultant for resume reviews!

Create saved searches to easily get notified when events and coffee chats are available

Ross Recruit: michiganross.12twenty.com

M MICHIGAN ROSS

- Home
- Profile
- Target Employers
- Employers
- Contacts
- Tasks
- Activity Stream
- Research Tools
- Job Listings
- Appointments
- My Calendar
- Events**
- Resume Books
- Recent Liked
- Morgan Manchester

Events

All Events

My Events

Employer, Event Name, or Keyword



End Date: All Future Event Type Employer Name + Add Filter Reset

List

Event	Event Status	Registration Status
 L.E.K. Consulting Coffee Chats MBA2 CH L.E.K. Consulting Coffee Chats/Office Hours 09/07/2023, 8:00am EDT Virtual	REGISTRATION OPEN	Not Registered
 Progressive Insurance General Management Information Session + Insomnia Cookies [...] Progressive Insurance Company Presentation 09/13/2023 4:45pm EDT R1210	REGISTRATION CLOSED	Not Registered

Turn on email alerts for this search

My Saved Searches & Alerts

Save Search

Saved Search Name*

Saved Search 2023-09-13

Notify me via email when there are new results

☒ Weekly ☐ Daily ☐ Disabled

Cancel

OK

You're getting a LOT of links... add bookmark folders for important links you want to reference later

The image shows a PowerPoint presentation on the left and a list of bookmark folders on the right. The PowerPoint is titled "PowerPoint" and "CC@R" and has tabs for "File", "Home", and "Insert". The "Home" tab is active, showing a slide with a yellow box containing the text "Resume development" and "Is consulting right for you?". Below this is a blue box with the text "This Week:" and a list of tasks: "Continue resume development", "Developing & practicing your Odyssey/elevator pitch and 'Why Consulting'", "Resume review **not** covered today", and "Sign up for CDO and Peer Coach appointments (non-consulting) on RR!". The slide is numbered 7. Below this is a slide numbered 8 titled "Booking appointments on Ross Recruit & CDO resource" with a screenshot of the Ross Recruit website. Below that is a slide numbered 9 titled "Create saved searches to easily get notified when events and coffee chats are available" with a screenshot of the Ross Recruit website. The bookmark folders on the right are: CC@R GDrive, Casebooks by School - CC@R: '22 - '23 Materials (...), Syllabus Book (2022.4.20).docx - Google Docs, Consulting - Case Log & Coffee Chat Tracker - Goo..., Case Log - Google Sheets, Case Interview Fundamentals, Mental Math Concepts, Ross Recruit, Bain - Recruiting Portal, Bain at University of Michigan, Ross School of Busi..., iMPact Resume, Action_Words.pdf, The Future Of Retail In The Beauty Industry Will Be..., VMock Dashboard, RocketBlocks: Interview prep for consulting and tech, and Statistics To Know For Case Interview | Manageme...

Foundational Fin Aid Recruiting News & Articles Courses CC@R

PowerPoint CC@R

File Home Insert

Resume development
Is consulting right for you?

This Week:

- Continue resume development
- Developing & practicing your Odyssey/elevator pitch and "Why Consulting"
- Resume review **not** covered today
- Sign up for CDO and Peer Coach appointments (non-consulting) on RR!

7 M MICHIGAN ROSS

8 Booking appointments on Ross Recruit & CDO resource

How It Recruit: michiganross.24munity.com

9 Create saved searches to easily get notified when events and coffee chats are available

How It Recruit: michiganross.24munity.com

CC@R GDrive

Casebooks by School - CC@R: '22 - '23 Materials (...)

Syllabus Book (2022.4.20).docx - Google Docs

Consulting - Case Log & Coffee Chat Tracker - Goo...

Case Log - Google Sheets

Case Interview Fundamentals

Mental Math Concepts

Ross Recruit

Bain - Recruiting Portal

Bain at University of Michigan, Ross School of Busi...

iMPact Resume

Action_Words.pdf

The Future Of Retail In The Beauty Industry Will Be...

VMock Dashboard

RocketBlocks: Interview prep for consulting and tech

Statistics To Know For Case Interview | Manageme...

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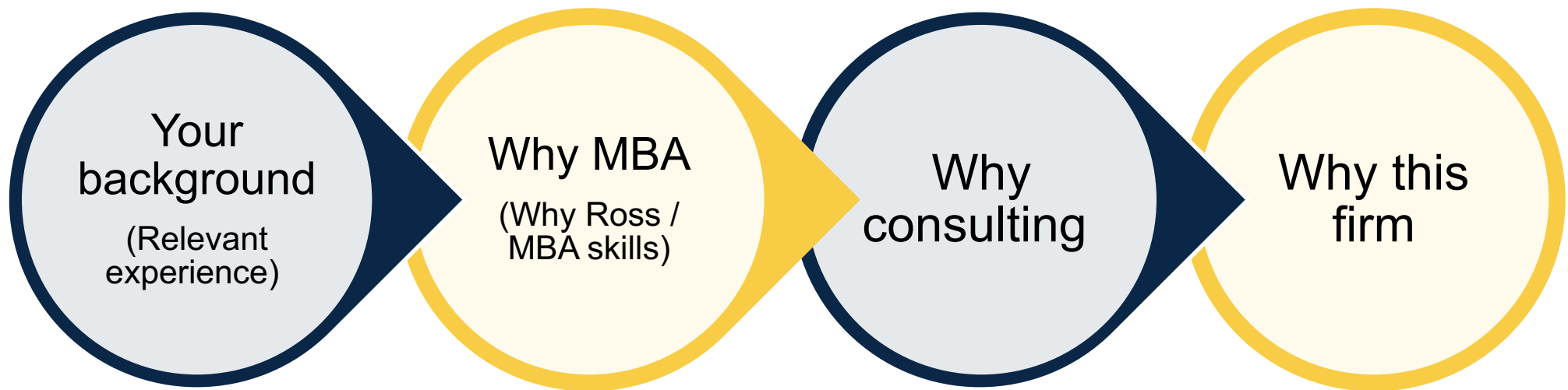
- **What is an Odyssey?**
 - What makes you interesting
 - Why consulting?
 - How your experiences will get you to where you want to go
 - Why this firm + why this city
- **Why have one?**
 - Introduce yourself and your background during networking groups + coffee chats + interviews
 - Tale as old as time: Framing your experience as a journey makes you memorable to the interviewer
 - Relate your prior experience + MBA experience to consulting core skills (i.e. show how you will be an excellent consultant)

Note – listen to the person you are talking to and make them want to get to know you; be mindful of what level of odyssey you deliver based on the situation (more to come)

Odyssey articulates your **value proposition** in a succinct, structured way to employers

What does structure to an odyssey mean?

There are 4 main components to your odyssey:



While structure is important, you also want to inspire through your story

- Firm representatives may hear up to 8-10 of these every day during recruiting season...
- ...so how do you inspire through your odyssey?

The Golden Circle

WHAT

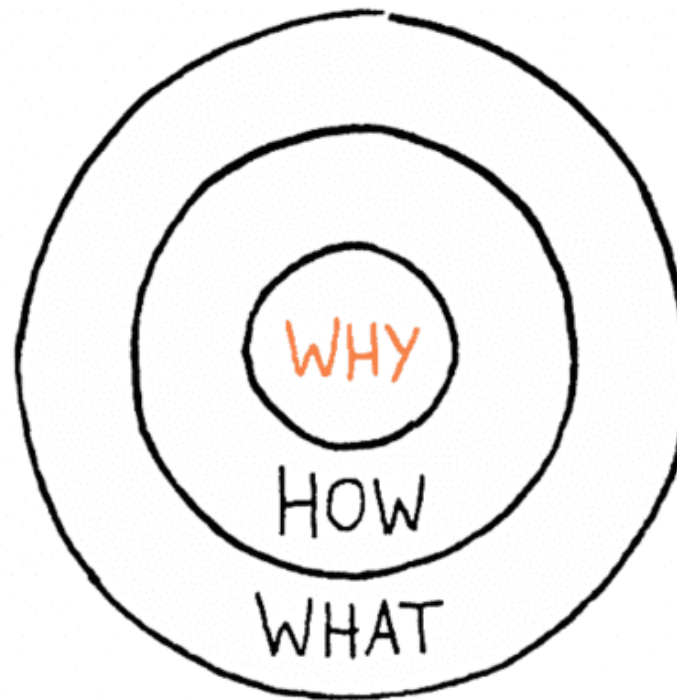
Every organization on the planet knows WHAT they do. These are products they sell or the services

HOW

Some organizations know HOW they do it. These are the things that make them special or set them apart from their competition.

WHY

Very few organizations know WHY they do what they do. WHY is not about making money. That's a result. WHY is a purpose, cause or belief. It's the very reason your organization exists.



[Simon Sinek - Start with the Why](#)

Good

In my prior roles as a recruiter, I worked closely with executive leadership to identify and hire talent in key practice areas

Better

Highlights: corporate strategy, strategy implementation, market assessment

Accurately reflects job duties but does not highlight many consulting core skills

Highlight your “why” and the core consulting skills you developed in your prior career

Remember that you do not need to have a business/econ/consulting background to have gained core consulting skills.

Good

In my prior roles as a recruiter, I worked closely with executive leadership to identify and hire talent in key practice areas

Better

My favorite part of my role as a recruiter was working with executive leadership to ensure the talent was in place to meet our corporate growth strategy.

Accurately reflects job duties but does not highlight many consulting core skills

Highlights: corporate strategy, strategy implementation, market assessment

Highlight your “why” and the core consulting skills you developed in your prior career

Remember that you do not need to have a business/econ/consulting background to have gained core consulting skills.

Great Non-Trad

“Given my nontraditional background, I’m pursuing my MBA to develop the quantitative / analytical skills that I will need to succeed as a consultant”

Great Technical

“I developed strong quantitative skills as an engineer, and I’m pursuing my MBA to learn the project management / qualitative analysis skills that I will need to succeed as a consultant”

Themes

Core Consulting Skills

*Think about what you are learning in your core classes right now and how that will help you.

Use your “Why MBA” to highlight how you are developing core consultant skills that you didn’t have in your prior career

Odyssey: Why Consulting (+ this firm + this city)

Yes

No

- Travel (client site $\neq$ vacation)
- Premier exit opportunities (highlight why you want to go into consulting, not out of it)
- \$\$\$

Impactful, concise story is important: firms are looking for candidates who have been thoughtful in their recruiting decisions, are 100% in on consulting + this firm

Make your why make sense.

Share your **unique + specific** reasons as much as possible

Odyssey: Why Consulting (+ this firm + this city)

Yes

- **Solving challenging problems**
- **Passion for specific industries/work at the firm**
- Exposure to many industries
- This firm's culture and values
- This firm's approach to development (ntl. vs office staffing model, generalist vs. specialized groups)
- This city's industry opportunities
- Be even more specific if you can!

No

- Travel (client site $\neq$ vacation)
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When to Adapt the Odyssey

Long: 2 min

- When: Behavioral Interviews
- What: Full Odyssey

Includes:

- Your Background
- Why MBA
- Why Consulting
- Why This Firm + This Office

Medium: 45-90 sec

- When: 1:1 Coffee Chats
- What: Most of Odyssey

Includes:

- Background Highlights
- Why MBA
- Why Consulting
- Why This Firm + This Office

Short: 20 sec

- When: Group Coffee Chats
- What: Just an intro

Includes:

- Most relevant background info
- Short Why Consulting

Micro: 5 Sec

- When: Networking Circles
- What: Very short intro

Includes:

- Industry background and type of consulting interest

The Airport Test

Would the interviewer want to be stuck in an airport with you?

Adapting to the Situation is Crucial

Do not give a 2-minute Odyssey during a 15-minute group coffee chat. *Why do you think this is a bad idea?*

Odyssey Observe A Pro – The long version



We will give you 3 examples then talk through what went well/didn't go well.

Be sure to think about the differences and the appropriate audiences for each!

*Examples can also be found in Appendix



- What was a major strength of each odyssey?
- What were your main takeaways?
- What would you be excited to talk to each person about?
- What could have been better?
- Hearing these examples, how will you frame yours?

Odyssey Observe A Pro - The short version



We will give you 3 examples then talk through what went well/didn't go well.

Be sure to think about the differences and the appropriate audiences for each!

*Examples can also be found in Appendix



- What was similar between the short and long versions?
- What was different between the short and long versions?
- What went well?
- What could have been better?

Exercise – In groups of 2, present your stories

- Does not have to be a strict Odyssey
- Focus on your journey, and why you made some transitions in your life (choice of college, job/role, coming to Ross etc.)
- Be conversational

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Resume - Key Points

Use Impact – there is no good reason not to!

Education – 10-20%

- MBA section will evolve over the next 2-3 months
- Includes emphasis (singular) or emphases (plural), concentration, certificate, involvement, and honors that are relevant to target companies

Experience – 60-70%

- Bullets within each position listed in order of importance to target recruiters
- All bullets are in Action-Context-Result (ACR) format:
- Bullet points are no more than 3 lines

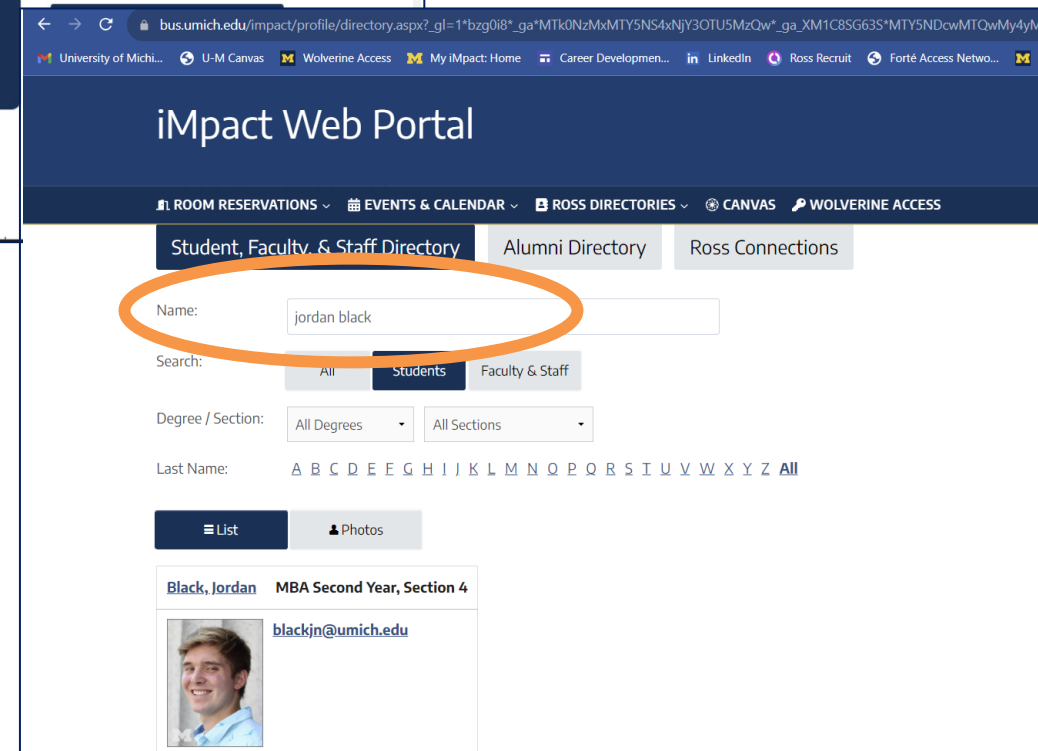
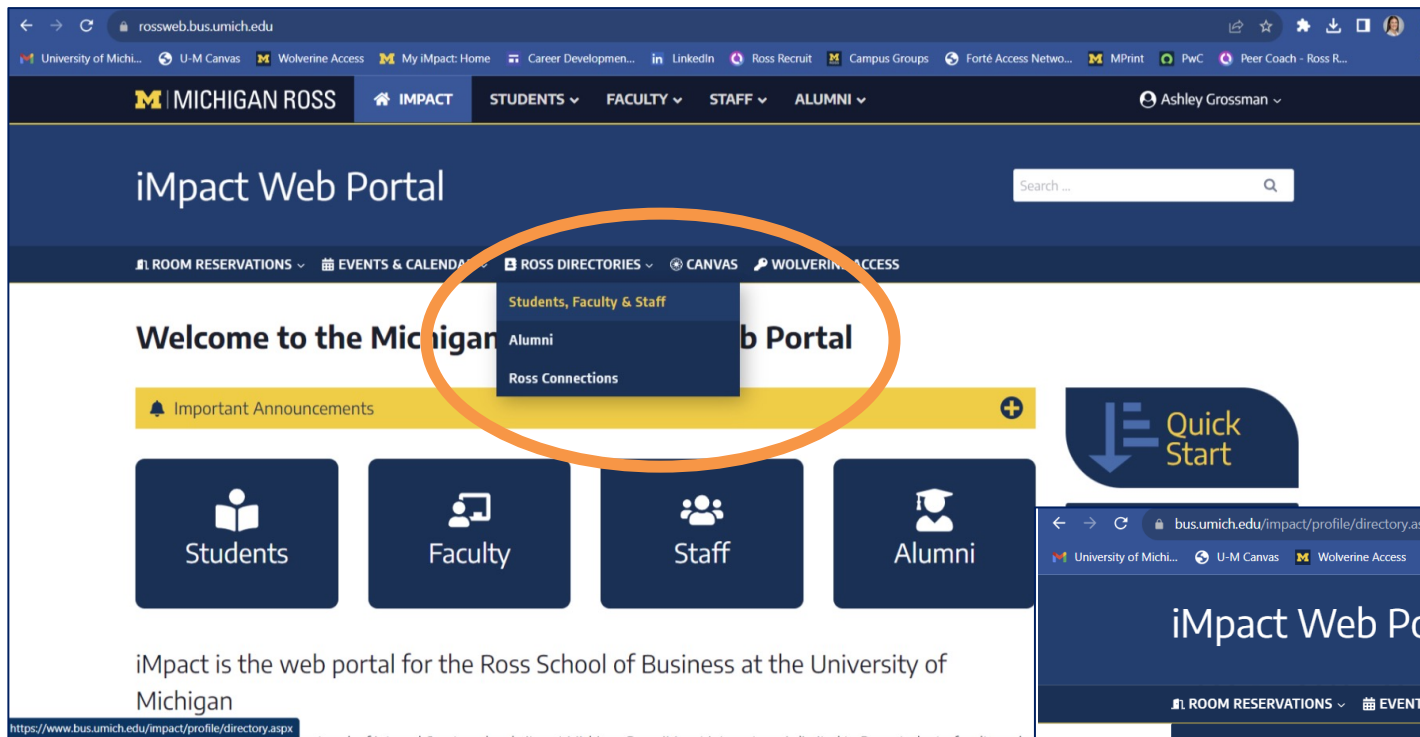
Additional – 10-20%

- ~3 one-line bullets to communicate personal interests and traits that differentiate you

Get your resume reviewed by peers, PCs and Randy!

Resources: [MBA Resume Checklist](#) and [Quick Tips - Consulting Resume](#)

As a starting point, you can access current MBA2's resumes on Impact



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Behavioral Questions: What are they?

Behavioral questions assess your experience and how you handled different actions (**past actions indicative of future behaviors**)

- “Tell me about a time when” questions
- Often the first 10 minutes before you start a case, but sometimes standalone 45-minute interview
- Opportunity to get to know your interviewer + for the interviewer to get to know you + set the tone before your case
- Behavioral themes will come up in coffee chats and having structure to your answers will help you stand out

Start working on your behavioral answers now!

Choose the best story
+
Structure your response
+
Practice
=
Successful Behavioral Interview

How to select stories?

- Do not try to anticipate individual questions (there are too many)!
- Prepare several “core” stories that can be used to answer a variety of questions
 - **Recommendation: 5 core stories and 3 backup stories**
 - Highlight Core Consulting Skills
 - Leadership
 - Teamwork
 - Resolve conflict
 - Persuade someone
 - Etc.
- **Homework:** document the names of your core stories

Behavioral Interview Prep – Next Steps

Once you have documented your 5-8 stories, your next steps will include:

- Build out your stories into ACR format
- Group stories thematically based on the question bank

Template: [Here](#)

<u>Possible Prompt</u>	<u>Keyword</u>
Tell me about a time when you took a step back on a project.	ALMOST FAILURE
Tell me about a time you dealt with a tough problem.	ALMOST FAILURE
Took a calculated risk	ALMOST FAILURE
What is the most important thing you look for in an employer?	CONSULTING
Why do you want to work at XX?	CONSULTING
Why management consulting?	CONSULTING
Why (insert firm name)?	CONSULTING
Can you remember a time you (nearly) failed at accomplishing a task.	FAILURE
Did you ever have a goal that you weren't able to achieve? What did you do?	FAILURE
Made a mistake	FAILURE
Tell me about a failure.	FAILURE
Tell me about a time you delivered bad news.	FAILURE
Describe a time when you challenged or changed the status quo.	INCOMPLETE INFO
Describe a time when you had to make a decision without complete information.	INCOMPLETE INFO
Had to act with incomplete info	INCOMPLETE INFO
Tell me about a time you had to make a recommendation without having all the facts.	INCOMPLETE INFO

CDO's Behavioral Story Prep: [Here](#)

Complete Feedback Form!



We actually read this feedback and are truly willing to make adjustments as needed. We want to make this the best experience for you that we can!

Appendix

Context

- **Keep it short:** Give the context needed for the interviewer to understand the actions you took
- Frame the problem: leave them asking, **“wow, how did you handle that?”**

Action

- Share what **you** did given the problem that shows the **core skill** the question asked
- **Add Structure:** “3 steps I took,” “2 factors I considered,” etc.
- *Be cautious of saying “we” here, and be sure to make the action is about what YOU did*

Result*

- Detail the impact of your actions
- Quantify where possible
- Include **learning** *only if it was profound or lifechanging* to show that you have a growth mindset + learned to adapt
- End on a positive note

Tips: spend most of your time on “Action” to show how your actions were critical to success; use first-person and action-based language

Odyssey Versions: Long vs Short

Long version

Your
background

I spent the last several years working in recruiting functions at two law firms. In these roles, I executed my firm's corporate growth strategy by hiring talent that positioned us as market leaders in key practice areas.

Why MBA

I really enjoyed this exposure to corporate growth strategy, and I came to Ross for my MBA to develop the quantitative and analytical skills needed to pursue this passion.

Why
consulting

I hope to pivot into consulting to help clients with their most pressing strategic problems. I've enjoyed learning about different industries through my coursework here at Ross...

Why this
firm

...which is why I'm excited about the [generalist program] at [Firm] for the opportunity to gain exposure to strategic corporate growth across a variety of industries.

Short
Version

My background is in law firm recruitment, where I was essentially the execution arm of my firms' growth strategy. I'm interested in consulting to pivot from execution functions into strategy development work.

Odyssey Examples

[Here](#)

I spent the last several years working in recruitment roles at two law firms...

Strategy

In my recruiting roles, I was essentially the execution arm of my firm's corporate growth strategy, as I would hire talent that would help us to achieve market-leading positions across target practice groups.

Human Capital

I really enjoyed learning how my firm's people strategy was central to its success. I hope to take my execution-focused HR experience to pivot into a strategy career as a human capital consultant.

Marketing

In my recruiting roles, I managed my firm's brand on law school campuses to market our hiring programs to top talent. I'm interested in leveraging this experience to help clients develop brand image and connect with customers.

Health Care

As a recruiter, I enjoyed getting exposure to my firm's corporate growth strategy. I have also volunteered in the healthcare industry as an EMT for 10 years. I'm passionate about a healthcare consulting career for the opportunity to merge my HC provider experience with my interest in corporate strategy.

- Always use the CAR format to structure your answers
- Here are some specific examples:
 - Tell me about your biggest professional accomplishment
 - Tell me about your biggest professional challenge
 - Tell me about a time when you encountered conflict on a team
 - Tell me about your analytical experience
 - Tell me about your leadership experience
- Thematic grouping may be helpful – keywords tie to specific behavioral stories
- *What do you think makes a good story in an interview setting?*
 - *Context?*
 - *Action?*
 - *Result?*